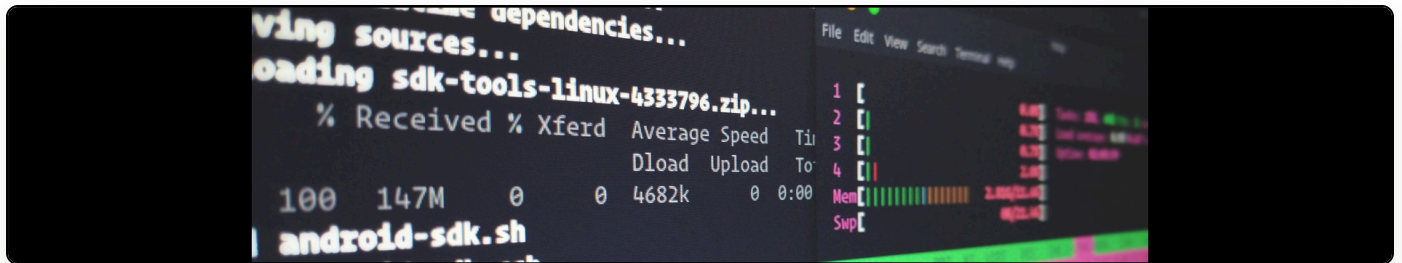


Determining glyph availability for FOP

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I've just spent the past hour grappling with getting FOP to render the Unicode glyph for a checkmark (U+2713) in PDF output from XSL:FO. I thought I'd share a few things I learnt along the way (that make me feel a bit silly for not knowing them already).

The type of errors I was getting were:

```
Glyph "✓" (0x2713, checkmark) not available in font "Times-Roman".
```

Some observations after messing around for far too long:

1. Fop does not support fallback to a secondary font on a character-by-character basis. If you need a glyph to be rendered that isn't present in your font, well, bad luck. (Unless you specifically tweak your XSL:FO document, which isn't viable in my case.)
2. There is no way, as far as I can see, that you can map a specific character to use a different font.
3. There is a [great resource at fileformat.info](http://fileformat.info) that will [tell you what fonts support your glyphs](#).
4. Just use DejaVu Sans and save yourself a lot of tweaking.